

Doomsday scenarios depicted in Al Gore's movie *An Inconvenient Truth* may seem frightening but we have to understand that such apocalyptic scenarios are a possibility. One should not dismiss these dangers as "climate porn".
A. DIGU, *Coimbatore*

I did not get what the columnist wants to say through this write-up. Is it supposed to be a sarcastic comment on the way people worry about everything today, or is it an actual reflection of what he thinks? Is he trying to tell us he chickens out of even thinking about environmental problems, let alone do something about them?
SONIA SINHA, *on e-mail*

Well Stated

Your report "India's Best Banks" (February 25) is nothing but naked truth. ICICI Bank knows nothing about banking laws and practices. It seems chairman K.V. Kamath wants just growth and does not care about the quality of services his bank offers to its clients.

M.P. BHAYA, *Pune*

Web of Deceit

Loopholes in laws and shoddy monitoring of hospitals and clinics has made it easier for doctors like Amit Kumar to carry on with their illegal activities ("Life and Crimes of a Kidney Don". February 25). Despite innumerable scams which are unearthed every other day, one is still forced to ask this question: will things ever change in our society?

SIKTA SAMANTARAY, *Cuttack*

High Fliers

The huge amount of money spent on foreign trips of ministers is shocking considering the fact that the country witnesses a suicide every half an hour by a poverty-stricken farmer ("Frequent Fliers", February 18).

GANESHAN, P., *Visakhapatnam*

What is exasperating is the uncanny knack with which these globe-trotting ministers manage to convert

their seemingly personal visits into official ones.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, *Bangalore*

Can increasing instances of foreign travels by ministers be taken as proof of the nation's wealth?

SUNITHA SASI, *Kochi*

The story was a letdown. There was much ado about nothing. The RTI could have been used in a more fruitful manner.

S.K. NANDA, *on e-mail*

REGIONAL DICHOTOMY



I do not support MNS's violence against the north Indians but it is true that these migrants are a burden on Mumbai ("No Jail Only Bail", February 25).

ANJUM M. SAMEL, *Mumbai*

Such a vituperative campaign has only exposed Raj Thackeray's political immaturity.

K.R. SRINIVASAN, *Hyderabad*

If Thackeray's "Mumbai for Maharashtrians" stand is regionalistic, what is the justification for Article 370—granting special status to Jammu and Kashmir—which is nothing more than state-sanctioned regionalism?

NITIN D. JOSHI, *on e-mail*

The manner in which Thackeray was arrested and then released makes one say "Mera Bharat Mahaan".

K.R.P. GUPTA, *on e-mail*

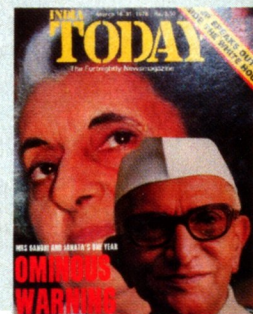
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Years Ago in India Today

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A Forgotten Dream

Jayaprakash Narayan, 75, Janata Party's spiritual *eminence grise*, is an angry man as the party completes one year in office. "I am disappointed with the party's performance," he says. The party, which came to power on the crest of a mass movement led by JP, is aware of his dissatisfaction. JP's house in Patna has suddenly become a place of pilgrimage for



Narayan Janata bigwigs including party president Chandra Shekhar and Union health minister Raj Narain. Some leaders including prime minister Morarji Desai and home minister Charan Singh are conspicuous by their absence. "These people are status conscious. They think they have achieved their present position through their own sacrifice and prayer." Speculation is rife that the party's renewed awareness of JP's existence has something to do with their efforts to 'soften' the old man.

—Ajay Singh